



1 Drone Deliveries Thriving Amid Covid-19

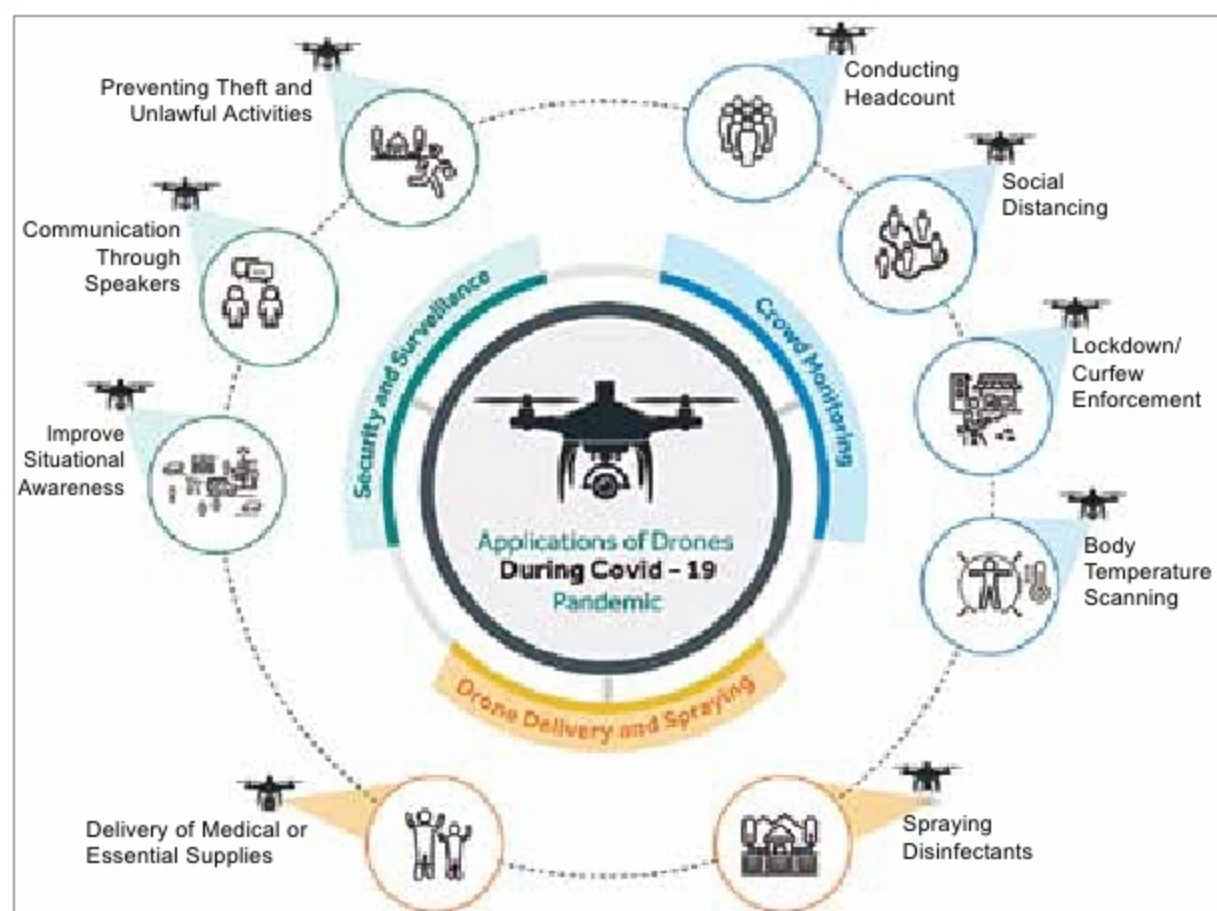
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## 1 DRONE DELIVERIES THRIVING AMID COVID-19

As India continues to tackle the ongoing crisis, drones have been playing a key role in combating the novel coronavirus. Drone startups in India are working alongside authorities to provide services such as disinfecting contaminated areas, managing crowds and delivering medical supplies



(Credit: [www.cyient.com](http://www.cyient.com))

The novel coronavirus is transmitted via respiratory droplets and can spread by touching contaminated surfaces like metal, floors, objects, and other surfaces indoors and outdoors. Remotely piloted drones are becoming vital tools in the fight against Covid-19 as they help to minimise human interaction and keep human operators safe from getting infected.

The law enforcement agencies across India are using drones to moni-

tor crowded areas, ensure social distancing, disinfect contaminated areas, oversee cargo, and provide medical supplies. The drones are equipped with HD thermal cameras for surveillance, police sirens, flashing lights, and loudspeakers to reach places where people are congregating. Wireless technology is enabling the police to make lockdown-related public announcements over speakers, supply medicines, or other essential goods for families living in quarantine.

The drone based surveillance is assisting ground forces to take correct decisions on moving forces to sensitive or congested areas. Visuals from the cameras of drones are helping monitor the situation, condition of the streets, and rooftop of the buildings to know if there are any projectiles, missiles, or stones kept there.

The governments of Telangana and Kerala are using a variety of drones for monitoring the public on roads, disinfectant spraying, and delivery of services. Similarly, Assam is using drones to keep an eye on religious places and large gatherings at markets and public places. Maharashtra is using data analytics and drones to deal with containment in crowded places like wholesale markets. To make sure citizens are safe and are inside their homes, Hyderabad is also using drone technology for surveillance of the city. The Gujarat police have deployed drones in Rajkot, meanwhile, Uttarakhand police also monitored the situation in Dehradun with the help of drone cameras.

Jammu and Kashmir police have also deployed drones for service in Srinagar as well as other parts of the valley to monitor the Covid-19 situation and make people aware of the restrictions imposed by the administration. To check whether there are any violations of prohibitory orders, the Delhi police and civic agencies have adopted drones as an extension of their forces. They are using drones